

Justification & Approval For Other than Full and Open Competition

As a legislative branch agency, the Library is subject to the competition and advertising requirements of 41 U.S.C. § 6101. Like the Competition in Contracting Act and the FAR, 41 U.S.C. § 6101 does not require competition when a contracting officer certifies that only one source or brand-name item is available, when dictated by public exigency, or when otherwise authorized by law.

This document sets forth the justification and approval for award of a contract or order by means providing for other than full and open competition per 41 U.S.C. § 6101, LCR 7-210, and, as applicable, FAR 6.302, FAR 13.106-1, FAR 8.405, and FAR 16.505. Contracting without competition shall not be justified on the basis of a lack of advance planning or concerns related to availability of funds.

This form shall be used to support instances where competition will be limited to a single source, a limited number of sources, including where a brand name product is required.

Part 1 – Identification

1. Contracting Agency and Activity: Library of Congress, LCSG/DPS/ABA/NDMSO

2. Nature of Action Being Approved

- ☒ Contract (or modification)
- ☐ LoC or Leg Branch Order (or modification)
- ☐ GSA Schedule or GWAC: Identify Schedule/Contract
- ☐ Other: Identify

Plan ID Number: 2026-LGD-0076
Contractor: Index Data LLC
Estimated Value (Base and all options): XXXXXXXXXX
Period of Performance: May 11, 2026 – Nov 10, 2026

3. Description of Supplies or Services Required to Meet Library Needs

The Library requires the following supplies or services:

The Library of Congress's BIBFRAME Linked Data System (BFLDS) currently works in tandem with FOLIO. FOLIO is a collaboration of libraries, developers, and vendors who are building an open source library services platform, with additional information found at www.folio.org.

The contractor shall develop baseline middleware that establishes a common way to harvest data from FOLIO, transform data to another format, push data to a different application, harvest data from a non-FOLIO application, and push data to FOLIO. The scope for this phase focuses on realizing the data exchange loop described in the previous sentence for cataloger triggered events (such as after updating a description) and not bulk data remediation or transfer. Focus shall be on successful data exchange and traceability, not speed or throughput.

The contractor shall produce middleware that:

- Harvests data from BFLDS using an endpoint that conforms to the Entity Metadata Management API 1.0
- Harvests MARC records from FOLIO using OAI-PMH (a common library standard with a 20+ year history)
- Transforms and routes data between FOLIO and BFLDS, complete with logging, error reporting, and replay/retry capability. Transformation pipelines will support LC-supplied or LC-approved XSLT-based transformations:
 - BIBFRAME → MARC/MARCXML (BFDB → FOLIO)
 - MARC/MARCXML → BIBFRAME (FOLIO → BFDB)
- Further, pipelines will be explicitly configured, versioned, and reusable.
- Exposes a REST-API and CLI for control and visibility

Part 2 – Program Office Justification & Approval

4. Authority for Contracting Without Competition Over \$350,000

Up to and including \$350,000

For this requirement up to \$350,000, using simplified acquisition procedures under FAR part 13, the basis for contracting without providing for full and open competition is:

- ☒ Only one responsible source is reasonably available to meet Library requirements. 41 U.S.C. § 6101(b); FAR 13.106-1.
- ☒ Product or service is reasonably available from only one source.
 - ☐ Source controls copyrights, patents or other exclusive licensing arrangements.
 - ☐ Urgent circumstances; only one source can reasonably deliver by required date. Option years are not permitted.
 - ☐ Source is expressly authorized or required by statute: Identify the authority
- ☐ Library's needs can only be satisfied by a brand-name product
- ☐ The Product is listed the Library of Congress Enterprise Architecture Repository (LCEAR) database (Attach applicable IT Standard Data Sheet)

5. Rationale for Contracting Without Competition

We are authorized to limit competition on the basis of the citation in section 4 because:

The Library of Congress's BIBFRAME Linked Data System (BFLDS) previously operated in tandem with Voyager and, as of June 2025, now interfaces with FOLIO as the Library's system of record. BFLDS consists of the BIBFRAME database (BFDB), Linked Data Service (LDS ID), and the Marva editor, with LDS ID and BFDB built on the MarkLogic platform, which incorporates triplestore functionality. BFLDS and FOLIO were developed using distinct and not fully compatible architectures, requiring specialized middleware to enable efficient interoperability.

Under contract LCLGD25C0002, IndexData conducted a comprehensive analysis, working directly with the original FOLIO developers, of how BFLDS and FOLIO can be integrated. This effort produced detailed, implementation-ready recommendations for middleware design, workflow optimization, and data exchange.

IndexData is uniquely qualified to perform this work due to its direct role in both the design and development of FOLIO and the development of core components of BFLDS. As a result, IndexData possesses institutional and technical knowledge of system architecture, design decisions, and integration constraints that is not documented to a level sufficient for transfer to another contractor without additional time and cost.

Awarding this requirement to another contractor would require the new contractor to independently reconstruct IndexData's prior analysis, reverse-engineer design decisions across both systems, and develop equivalent expertise. This would result in significant duplication of effort, increased cost to the Government, and schedule delays.

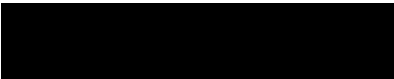
Accordingly, IndexData is the only responsible source capable of meeting the Library's requirement within the required timeframe, without duplication of costs.

6. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition Before Subsequent Contract Is Required

To increase competition, we will: continue to survey the environment for possible expertise.

7. Program Office Certification

I certify that the description of the Government's minimum needs, schedule requirements, and technical information that provide the basis for this justification are accurate and complete.

	Procurement Analyst		1/20/26
Name	Title	Signature	Date

PART 3 – CONTRACTING OFFICER DETERMINATIONS & CERTIFICATION

8. Efforts to Solicit from As Many Potential Sources As Practicable

Unless a justification is based on FAR 6.302-2, Unusual and compelling urgency, contracting officers shall post justifications for other than full and open competition, including brand name justifications, to the Contract Opportunities website on sam.gov (or eBay for Brand Name Justifications under FAR Part 8) prior to requesting a proposal or otherwise entering into negotiations.

- ☐ Advance notice will be published in sam.gov for 15 days before a contract is awarded. FAR 5.203(a).
- ☒ Advance or concurrent notice will be published in sam.gov for a reasonable time for commercial items FAR 5.203(a) and 12.204(b).
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published because the action meets the following FAR exception:
- ☐ Notice would compromise national security. FAR 5.202(a)(1).
 - ☐ Unusual and compelling urgency; notice period would seriously injure Government. FAR 5.202(a)(2).
 - ☐ Expressly authorized or required to be made through another Government agency. FAR 5.202(a)(4).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against an IDIQ contract awarded under FAR 16.5. FAR 5.202(a)(6).
 - ☐ Order will be placed against GSA schedule or other competitively-awarded contract. FAR 5.202(a)(11).
 - ☐ Other:
- ☐ Advance notice will not be published per 41 U.S.C. § 6101; see attached deviation from the FAR per LCR 7-210 § 3.A.

We made the following efforts to interest potential sources in this award: a justification for other than full and open competition will be posted to SAM.gov as a pre-solicitation notice prior to requesting a quote or otherwise entering into negotiations, in accordance with LC06.305 Availability of the Justification.

9. Listing of Sources That Expressed Interest in Writing

The following sources expressed interest in this award: None

10. Additional Information

The following additional information is relevant to this justification and approval: None

11. Contracting Officer Determination that Price Is Fair and Reasonable

As explained in detail below, I have determined that the prices for this contracting action are fair and reasonable based on comparison of the prices to the following (see FAR 15.404-1(b)(2)):

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☒ Historical prices paid by the Government | ☐ Published competitive price lists |
| ☒ Library's Independent Government Estimate | ☐ Prices obtained through market research |
| ☐ Other: | ☐ Prices obtained through competitive proposals |

The following analysis (based on attached pricing information) supports my determination: This action is valued at approximately [REDACTED] as documented in the Library's IGCE. Once a quote has been submitted by IndexData, their pricing data, such as level of effort and unit prices, will be compared to the Library's IGCE, in addition to the pricing provided in their prior contract LCLGD25C0002. It is anticipated that similar labor categories and levels of expertise will be required for this work, providing an accurate comparison for price analysis. Award will only be made after a price reasonableness determination has been made.

12. Contracting Officer Determination of Responsibility

- ☒ Checked System for Award Management (or will check in the case of competitive proposals for a brand name product)

13. Contracting Officer Determination of Best Value

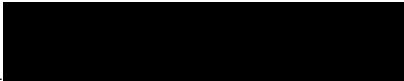
I have determined that this action represents the best value to the Government because: As previously stated, IndexData is uniquely qualified to perform this work due to its direct role in both the design and development of FOLIO and the development of core components of BFLDS. As a result, IndexData possesses institutional and technical knowledge of system architecture, design decisions, and integration constraints that is not documented to a level sufficient for transfer to another contractor without additional time and cost. Therefore, awarding to IndexData therefore provides the

best value to the Government as it will allow the Library to retain required expertise and minimize duplicable costs on a limited budget.

14. Contracting Officer Certification

I certify that, to the best of my knowledge and belief, this justification is accurate and complete. For those actions up to \$900,000, I approve contracting without competition for this requirement.

Veronica L. Price
Name


Signature

4/10/2026
Date